Weekly Sales Meeting in English: Results, Stock Issues & Action Plan

Situation: It is Monday at 9:30 AM in the head office. The Head of Sales meets one-on-one with a Regional Sales Manager while other team members are traveling or on leave. They need to review last week's performance and agree on three key priorities in twenty minutes.
David — Head of Sales at a beverage manufacturer · **Anna** — Regional Sales Manager at a beverage manufacturer

Transcript

David: Good morning, Anna. How was your weekend?
Anna: Good morning, David. It was quiet and restful, thanks.
David: Great. Let's make this Monday meeting quick and focused.
Anna: Sounds good. The others are visiting clients today, right?
David: Yes, Tom is in the south and Sarah is on leave.
Anna: Okay, so it is just the two of us today.
David: Exactly. **Let's look at the numbers.**
Anna: Sure. We closed last week at ninety-four percent of the target.
David: Ninety-four percent is not bad, but we missed the goal.
Anna: Yes, but we have some positive results too.
David: I saw that. The two new supermarket chains did very well.
Anna: They exceeded their sales plan by twelve percent.
David: That is great news. Well done.
Anna: The initial promotions in their stores worked really well.
David: Excellent work on those new accounts, Anna.
Anna: Thank you. The store managers were very cooperative.
David: Did they take all five products?
Anna: They started with three products, but demand was strong.
David: Can we list the other two products soon?
Anna: Yes, I plan to talk to their buyers this Thursday.
David: Perfect. We will add that to our plan later.
Anna: Now, let us discuss the missing six percent.
David: Yes, let's talk about the distributor, Delta Logistics.
Anna: They did not place their regular weekly order on Friday.
David: What went wrong here? Did Delta explain why?
Anna: Their inventory manager says their warehouse is completely full.
David: Full with our products, or with general goods?
Anna: Mostly our slow-moving drinks from last month's campaign.
David: I see. Why didn't they inform us earlier?
Anna: They only realized it on Thursday during their stock check.
David: And their sales team did not push the stock to retailers?
Anna: Honestly, their sales reps were busy with other brands.
David: It is easy to blame them, Anna.
Anna: I know, but they promised to sell fifty pallets last week.
David: Let's focus on solutions. Excuses will not help.
Anna: You are right. Complaining will not help our numbers.

David: Exactly. **How can we fix this?**
Anna: We need to help them move those slow items quickly.
David: What kind of support can we offer them right now?
Anna: We could run a yellow-tag discount for their wholesale customers.
David: Do we have budget in trade marketing for that?
Anna: We have around eight hundred euros left for this quarter.
David: Is that enough to cover promotional stickers too?
Anna: Yes, we already have printed materials in the office.
David: That should be enough for a quick two-week push.
Anna: I can also visit their sales team tomorrow morning.
David: A joint meeting with their sales reps is a great idea.
Anna: I can explain the promo and set clear targets for them.
David: Can you offer a small incentive for their top rep?
Anna: A fifty euro voucher usually motivates them very well.
David: Approved. Take it from our team budget.
Anna: Great. That will get their team excited.
David: That makes sense to me. Good plan, Anna.
Anna: Once stock drops below forty percent, they will order again.
David: When do you think they can place the next order?
Anna: If the promo starts Wednesday, they will order by Friday.
David: Good. Friday is the cut-off for weekly reporting.
Anna: I will make sure they send the purchase order by noon.
David: Now, let's look at the rest of the week.
Anna: We need to keep the momentum going.
David: Let's agree on three priorities. What is first?
Anna: Priority number one is definitely Delta Logistics and their inventory.
David: Agreed. You handle the promo setup and the team visit.
Anna: Who is responsible for this? Is it me?
David: You own the distributor relationship, so it is your task.
Anna: Got it. I will coordinate with marketing on the discount materials.
David: When can you deliver this? What is your deadline?
Anna: I will send the promo brief to marketing by two o'clock today.
David: Clear. What should be our second priority?
Anna: The second priority should be expanding the two new retail chains.
David: Yes, getting the remaining two products onto their shelves.
Anna: I will prepare the sales data and offer it on Thursday.
David: Offer a small listing discount if they agree this week.
Anna: Five percent off the first delivery should do the trick.
David: Sounds good. And what is our third priority?
Anna: We need to fix our weekly forecasting process.
David: Good point. We should not be surprised by full warehouses.
Anna: I can check client stock levels every Thursday afternoon.
David: That will give us twenty-four hours to react before Friday orders.
Anna: Yes, that will avoid unexpected cancellations.
David: Will you document this new check in our CRM?
Anna: Yes, I will add a simple stock alert field.

David: Great. That covers our main business risks.
Anna: Let's recap our action plan before we finish.
David: Number one: visit Delta Logistics and launch the promo.
Anna: Deadline is Wednesday morning, owned by me.
David: Number two: present the two new products to the supermarket chains.
Anna: The meeting is on Thursday, owner is me.
David: Number three: implement the Thursday stock check in CRM.
Anna: Deadline is Friday afternoon, and I will test it myself.
David: Very clear. That was fast and productive.
Anna: We finished the meeting in under twenty minutes.
David: That is how weekly meetings should be.
Anna: I will send a quick summary email right now.
David: Thanks, Anna. Let's have a great week.
Anna: Thank you, David. Talk to you soon.

Key phrases from this episode

Let's look at the numbers.	Let us examine the sales figures. — Let's look at the numbers before we make a decision. — Let's look at the numbers from the last marketing campaign.
That is great news.	I am very happy to hear that. — That is great news about your new contract. — The client signed the agreement? That is great news.
What went wrong here?	Why did this problem happen? — What went wrong here during the product launch? — The delivery is late again, so what went wrong here?
Let's focus on solutions.	Let us think about how to solve the problem. — We made a mistake, but let's focus on solutions now. — Don't argue about the past; let's focus on solutions.
How can we fix this?	What can we do to correct the situation? — We lost a big client, so how can we fix this? — How can we fix this issue before the audit starts?
That makes sense to me.	I understand and agree with your idea. — Your schedule looks realistic, so that makes sense to me. — That makes sense to me; let's try your proposal.
Let's agree on three priorities.	Let us choose the three most important tasks. — Before we end the meeting, let's agree on three priorities. — Let's agree on three priorities for the next quarter.
Who is responsible for this?	Which person owns and does this task? — Who is responsible for this report each Friday? — Who is responsible for this client account now?
When can you deliver this?	What is your deadline for completing this task? — I need the proposal soon; when can you deliver this? — When can you deliver this revised contract to legal?
Let's recap our action plan.	Let us quickly repeat who does what. — Let's recap our action plan before everyone leaves. — We have five minutes left, so let's recap our action plan.

Common mistakes

✗ Not: ~~They exceeded their sales plan on twelve percent.~~
✓ Better: **They exceeded their sales plan by twelve percent.**
Use 'by' (not 'on') to express the margin or amount of difference.

✗ Not: ~~Now, let us discuss about the missing six percent.~~
✓ Better: **Now, let us discuss the missing six percent.**
Do not use 'about' after the verb 'discuss'. It takes a direct object.

✗ Not: ~~Why they didn't inform us earlier?~~
✓ Better: **Why didn't they inform us earlier?**
In direct questions, place the auxiliary verb before the subject.

✗ Not: ~~Who is responsible of this specific action?~~
✓ Better: **Who is responsible for this specific action?**
The adjective 'responsible' takes the preposition 'for', not 'of'.

✗ Not: ~~We finished meeting in under twenty minutes.~~
✓ Better: **We finished the meeting in under twenty minutes.**
Singular countable nouns like 'meeting' need an article like 'the'.

Quiz

1. What was the team's total sales result last week?
A) They reached 94% of their target.
B) They exceeded the target by 12%.
C) They missed the target by 20%.

2. Why did Delta Logistics fail to place an order?
A) Their warehouse was completely full.
B) They switched to a cheaper supplier.
C) Their payment was delayed by the bank.

3. How does David handle Anna's complaints about Delta?
A) He fires the distributor immediately.
B) He shifts the focus to finding solutions.
C) He blames Anna for poor communication.

4. What action will Anna take to clear distributor stock?
A) Cancel all future shipments.
B) Launch a yellow-tag wholesale discount.
C) Increase prices by five percent.

5. What is the third weekly priority agreed upon?
A) Hiring new regional sales managers.
B) Traveling to south region retail stores.
C) Adding a Thursday stock check in CRM.

Answers: 1-A 2-A 3-B 4-B 5-C

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